



“AN ARMY OF DEER **LED BY A LION** IS MORE TO BE FEARED THAN AN ARMY OF LIONS **LED BY A DEER.**”

Attributed to **Philip II, king of Macedonia**, 4th century BCE

was killed in battle in 362 BCE, Theban power was rapidly eclipsed.

In India, the **Nanda dynasty** began its **expansion** in the 370s BCE, and continued to expand until it was able to take power from the Shishunaga in 345 BCE. The dynasty's founder **Mahapadma Nanda** conquered much of north India, building up a huge army. He operated an efficient administrative system with centrally appointed tax collectors and undertook irrigation works. However, the deposition of Dhana Nanda in 321 BCE was followed by the **absorption of the Nanda empire into the Mauryan empire**.

The **state of Chu** was the most southerly of China's **Warring States**, centered on the Middle Yangzi River. Throughout the 5th century BCE it annexed a number of states, becoming the dominant power by 380 BCE. In 366 BCE a resounding victory by the state of **Qin** against the armies of **Hann** and

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THE AGE OF MAGAPADMA NANDA AT HIS DEATH

Wei, followed by another defeat of Wei at the **battle of Shimen** in 364 BCE led to Chu's decline and the shift eastward of Wei's royal center to Daliang. A rejuvenated Wei was strong enough to force the rulers of four other Warring States to attend its court in 356 BCE. Wei's supremacy was short-lived, and defeats inflicted on it by Qi armies at Guiling in 353 BCE and Maling in 341 BCE reduced it to a Qi vassal.

IN 359 BCE PERDICCAS III OF Macedonia died and his successor, **Philip II** (r. 359–337 BCE) began to transform the position of what had been regarded by other Greeks as a very minor kingdom. In 357 BCE, he made his first major conquest, Amphipolis in Thrace. He became involved in the **Third Sacred War** (356–346 BCE), which was fought over perceived violations by Sparta and Phocis of the sacred oracle at Delphi, using this to cement his position as an important player in the power politics of central Greece and the Peloponnese. In the 340s, Philip strengthened his position in Thessaly and became involved in petty disputes between the city-states, as rival factions turned either to him or to Athens for support. In 340 BCE **open war** broke out between Philip and the Athenian-Theban alliance. Just two years later, at Chaeronea in Boeotia, **Philip defeated the**

PHILIP OF MACEDONIA (382–336 BCE)

Philip II reformed the Macedonian army and forced the Greek states to join a League of Corinth under Macedonian control. After his return to Macedonia, he took a new wife, Cleopatra, but was stabbed to death at his wedding feast, possibly on the orders of his son, Alexander the Great, who stood to lose his position if Cleopatra bore another heir.



Athenians and annihilated the Theban Sacred Band (see 380–371 BCE). Macedonian power in Greece was now unchallenged.

Rome's steady expansion in central Italy had caused alarm among its neighbors. This led to a bitter six-year struggle with the town of Tibur from 360 BCE, among other conflicts. In 340 BCE, a general **war broke out between Rome and the Latins**, who inhabited the modern region of Lazio around Rome. The Romans had just emerged from a war with the Samnites, a people who inhabited the central Apennines, and the Latins took

advantage of Rome's exhausted state to launch an attack. During the first year of the war, at a battle near Vesuvius, the consul Publius Decius Mus is said to have dedicated his body to the gods of the underworld and then undertaken a suicidal charge against the Latin ranks that turned the tide of battle in the Romans' favor. By 338 BCE, the **Romans had defeated the Latin League**. The peace terms were favorable, with many Latins being granted Roman citizenship. The League was then dissolved, and many of the former Latin cities were absorbed into the Roman state, moving Rome further toward complete dominance of central Italy.

In Peru, the **Nazca culture** began around 350 BCE. These people created mysterious geoglyphs, huge lines in the desert creating animal and abstract shapes, which cannot be made out from the ground.

Mausoleum of Halicarnassus *Mausolus was the Persian satrap (governor) of a region of south-western Turkey. After his death in 353 BCE his wife built a tomb for him, which became one of the Seven Wonders of the Ancient World.*



361 BCE A joint Egyptian-Spartan force attacks the Persian-controlled cities of Phoenicia

359 BCE Philip II becomes king of Macedonia

358 BCE In Persia, Artaxerxes III succeeds revolt. Fearing possible rivals, he has his whole family massacred

359 BCE Nectanebo II ascends the Egyptian throne

356 BCE Shang Yang, chancellor of the western Chinese state of Qin, introduces **wide-ranging reforms**; he increases the power of centralized government and introduces a rigorous penal code

356 BCE “Sacred War” between Athens and Phocis begins over access to the sacred temple and oracle of Delphi

348 BCE Philip of Macedonia gains control of the Chalcidic peninsula

346 BCE Peace between Philip of Macedon and Athens

343 BCE Dionysius II surrenders to Timoleon, who led a band of mercenaries to Sicily

342 BCE Persian invasion puts an end to Egyptian independence

338 BCE Rome defeats and dissolves the Latin League

338 BCE Artaxerxes III of Persia dies of poisoning and is replaced by Arses, his younger son

346 BCE Dionysius II becomes Tyrant of Sicily

342 BCE Philip of Macedonia conquers Thrace

341 BCE War breaks out between Rome and the Latin League

338 BCE Philip of Macedonia defeats coalition of Greek states and gains control of most of Greece

337 BCE Philip of Macedonia announces plans to liberate the Ionian Greek cities in Asia Minor